



DAVID SHAW
JUNE 3RD, 2021

DA VITTORIO MENU

AMUSE BOUCHES

Carrot Orange Tart
Russian Snow Crab with its Gelée and Snow Pea Purée
Blue Cheese and Saffron Arancini

SELECTION OF HOUSEMADE BREAD

Focaccia, Grissini, Pane Sfogliato, Mini Croissant, and Sourdough

BEEF TARTARE

New Zealand Black Angus Tenderloin Tartare “Stile Lombardo”
Served with Iceberg Lettuce Salad Finished with Quinoa and Miso

CAVIAR

Egg "à la Egg" and Superior Amur Oscietra Caviar from Sichuan
Served on top of a 「Martini」 of Baked Granny Smith, Scrambled Quail Egg, Ikura, Sour Cream, Potato Purée

TRILOGY OF FOIE GRAS

Apricot and Foie Gras Parfait with Butter Bread
Foie Gras Terrine Marinated in Gemma de sole from Calabria, Served with Cherry, Pistachio, Onion Cracker, and Duck Consommé Gelée
Foie Gras Poached in a Spiced Duck Consommé, Finished with Beetroot, Daikon, Onion, and Bok-Choy

VITTORIO STYLE PACCHERI PASTA

With Four Cultivars of Tomato from Sicilia, Toscana, Dalian, and Shandong

TOOTHFISH

Patagonian Toothfish, Sour Green Melon and Culatello di Zibello DOP
Sour Green Melon Purée, Basque Pil Pil Sauce, and BBQ Melon Juice Culatello Foam

NEW ZEALAND SCAMPI

Scampi Roasted with Beurre Noisette, Served with Scampi Consommé
Char-Grilled Scampi Tail, Brushed with a Pine Nut and Piquillo Peppers Pesto, Coated by a 「Shell」 of Scampi Meringue
Poached Scampi Wrapped in an Egg 「Soufflé」 Served with Scampi Sauce and Nori Powder

CHEESE

Beppino Occelli al Barolo, Paired with Pepperoni Apple Sauce, Kumquat Marmalade, and Caramelized Onion

PALATE CLEANSER

Pineapple and Passionfruit Sorbet, Marinated Pineapple Cannolo Filled with Tonka Bean Cream, Lemongrass and Coconut Foam, Praline

STRAWBERRY

Fresh Strawberry, Strawberry Sablé, Strawberry Gelato, Strawberry Syrup, and Strawberry Foam
Pistachio, and Sponge Cake Filled with Cardamom and Yogurt Foam

SORBETS AND GELATOS

Mango Sorbet, Chocolate Gelato, and Pistachio Gelato

MIGNARDISE

Handmade Chocolate Gelato Popsicle, Light Coffee Puff, Mango and Passionfruit Macaron,
Campania Style Babà al Limoncello, Strawberry Sorbet Filled White Chocolate on Top of Basil Biscuit, Thyme Infused Watermelon Jus

CANNOCCINO

Vanilla Cream and Hazelnuts



The prix-fixed lunch unfolds on a trio of amuse bouches. First up is a tartlet consisting of a well-executed thin-layered tart base holding contrasting textures of confit carrot and carrot-orange purée accented with fresh tough of lemon. The gradient scale from the bright citrusy acidity extracted from lemon to the neutral sweet-sour orange and finally the creamy sweet carrot is what made this small bite yet rich and amusing. While the carrot and orange are the stars of the tart, the thin tart also plays an important role as it provides essential airy crispness to counter the soft texture.

After the vegetarian tart that kicks off the start, Da Vittorio presents me with the second amuse bouche featuring snow crab meat from Russia. Resting on top of snow pea purée, the snow crab is coated with its own gelée that imparts sweet umami as well as euphoric acidity. The natural sweetness of the crab meat is counterpointed not only by the citrusy note that composes the ponzu-like gelée but also by the refreshing sweetness imparting from the pea purée. Both the pea and the snow crab showcase subtle sweetness and refreshing umami in similar yet altered ways. A perfect dish to counter the heat of summer, to calm down the diner, and to open up the palate.





The final amuse brioche from the trio is an arancini filled with blue cheese and saffron. Arancini is basically a traditional Italian fried risotto rice ball. In this amuse bouche I failed to pick up either the blue cheese or the saffron, it tastes like nothing but pure rice. The presence of this amuse bouche is also kind of prompt as both of the previous ones are light and refreshing. I am not set to prepare for the sudden shift from the botanic and oceanic refreshing sweetness to the heavy greasiness of the arancini balls. The temperature of the arancini is also remarkably high, which seems improper for this summer menu.

Da Vittorio is known for offering arguably one of the best bread selections in Shanghai. The ultra soft focaccia is indeed impressive as it showcases an airy texture with just the right amount of moisture, but the rest of the bread varieties are simply mediocre. Grissini is without doubt the best among the rest, but could be better if crispier. The mini croissant and the pane sfogliato do have an airy texture, however, the puff pastry isn't chewy enough. The sourdough would be better if with higher acidity.





The first appetizer is the notorious beef tartare which is on the menu of their Italian headquarter for over a half-century. The raw beef is mixed with lemon juice, black pepper, raw egg, fleur de sel, artichoke, mushroom, ketchup, caper, pickled cucumber, onion, parsley, mustard Sauce. Lea & Perrins Worcestershire Sauce is added at an early stage to extract the umami, special olive oil labeled as “Olieria Fratelli Manenti Extra Virgin Olive Oil DOP Umbria Colli Assisi Spoleto” is also applied constantly, finally drops of Martell Noblige Cognac are introduced in order to reach the final equilibrium.

The mixture is then rested for over ten minutes to be fully marinated. Such a complex style is sourced from the Lombardy area of Italy which is strongly influenced by French cuisine. With one bite, you would probably not be able to pick out each ingredient but simply a harmonious symphony that comforts your palate with perfect equilibrium among the rich unctuousness and umami of the beef, the exuberant oriental spiciness, the ambitious peppery heats, and the refreshing sour & sweet combo. Paired with the tartare is an iceberg lettuce salad finished with quinoa and miso. The lettuce per se is grilled, resulting in its rich smoky aroma.





With a reputation equivalent to the beef tartare's, the famous caviar course is unfortunately a disaster. The superior Amur Oscietra caviar from Sichuan is nestling on top of a glass of “martini” which consists of baked Granny Smith, scrambled quail egg, ikura, sour cream, and potato purée. For the “martini” per se, scrambled egg and potato purée showcase dominating greasiness that veil the subtle acidity of granny smith and sour cream. Moreover, the green apple is the only refreshing element. The sour cream imparts creaminess that counterweights its acidity, and the ikura carries oceanic brininess that offsets its explosiveness. The portion of the “martini” in contrast to the portion of the caviar is greatly oversized, engulfing the caviar in a swamp of unbearable heaviness and creaminess. It is such a shame that the caviar is almost undetectable.





After the disaster of caviar, we are served with a trilogy of foie gras. The first foie gras parfait is executed in one of the most fashionable interpretations that probably got its fame after the notorious creation of “Meat fruit” by chef Heston Blumenthal. In this case, the foie gras lacks brininess which is essential for the umami to come out. The apricot coating is also insufficient of flavor, not to mention that the bread aside is not crispy enough to create the balance texturewise.

The second foie gras dish showcases a much better interpretation and finally consoles us. Here the terrain is not only paired with the classic never-go-wrong pistachio and cherry jam but also pre-marinated in Gemma de sole from Calabria, which offers important depth and Italian mark to the foie gras.

The presence of the duck consommé gel and the onion cracker further elevated the dish with multi-dimensional textures. The cherry as the central element function in multiple ways that not only provides sourness to counter the foie gras but also imparts depth that shines along with the wine.





The third foie gras is prepared in a completely different way. Here the foie gras is kept in its original form and is poached in a consommé accented by bay leaf, clove, and anise. Such execution of foie gras unveils great Asian or Japanese influences, ushering our palate to tranquility. The selected vegetables, namely beetroot, daikon, onion, and bok-choy, add a refreshing herbal touch to the consommé.

After the appetizer, we tried the most signature and traditional pasta dish, the Vittorio style Paccheri pasta. It is cooked with parmigiana reggiano cheese and herbs, then finished with four cultivars of tomato sourcing from Sicilia, Toscana, Dalian, and Shandong. In spite of the simple ingredients, the flavor in this dish is truly symphonic and multi-dimensional. Layers of nuances are blended so well and dance in perfect harmony with each other.





Da Vittorio is famous for their seafood, hence the two seafood dishes we ordered. Unfortunately, with the high standard set by Le Bernardin, we are no longer satisfied with the seafood dishes at Da Vittorio. Our first dish features the Patagonian toothfish, which is similar to cod. Here it is paired with sour green melon and its puree, a special Italian ham called Culatello di Zibello DOP, Basque Pil Pil sauce, and BBQ melon juice culatello foam. The flesh per se evokes nothing but a mediocre palate, moreover, the sour lemon and the culatello also impart incongruity.

After the disappointing toothfish, Da Vittorio's highly praised scampi continues to let us down. The scampi course comes in three dishes, first in the row is a scampi tail roasted in beurre noisette then bathed in the scampi consommé. The execution is rather simple and boring, and the flesh is way overcooked that resulting in an extremely dry sensation on the palate. The consommé resembles the thin version of lobster bisque. It is well-executed but nothing comes with spirits.





The second serve of the scampi course consists of a char-grilled scampi tail. The tail is brushed with pine nut and piquillo peppers pesto and then coated by a “shell” of scampi meringue. The shell is unfortunately wet and mushy, and it functions like a seal that envelopes all the moisture of the scampi, resulting in an additional steaming process so that the flesh of the scampi turns out to be overcooked. The third one of poached scampi in an egg soufflé has the same problem. The soufflé per se is terribly watery and mushy that reminds me of overcooked egg chawanmushi.

After the sad main courses, we add a cheese course before desserts. We choose the Beppino Occelli al Barolo cheese, which has dried Barolo Nebbiolo grapes on top of the cheese. It is served with pepperoni apple sauce, kumquat marmalade, and caramelized onion.





Before we move on to the sweets, a palate-cleanser is served. This dish consists of pineapple and passionfruit sorbet, lemongrass and coconut foam, praline, and marinated pineapple cannolo filled with tonka bean cream. The reinterpretation of the traditional cannolo by using pineapple as the pastry is creative and effective. For the first dessert course, we order a strawberry dessert with sponge cake filled with cardamom and yogurt foam, as well as pistachio and fresh strawberry with its sablé, gelato, syrup, and foam. The texture of the sponge cake is very rustic, and the flavor overall is not very cohesive. For the next dessert, we choose to have some simple sorbeto and gelati. Mango sorbet has a very rich tropical fruitiness, and the chocolate and pistachio gelati carry a velvety texture that no one could resist.





The mignardise session is composed of two fresh fruity ones, two chocolatey ones, a neutral one which is a sponge cake with neutral flavor that is further sublimated by bathing in the Italiano spirit known as Limoncello with a light flavor, and final thyme-infused watermelon jus that serves as a palate cleanser that calls the end for the mignardise session.

We start from the strawberry sorbet-filled white chocolate on top of a basil biscuit. Inside the thin and crispy chocolate shell is, unfortunately, the almost melted strawberry sorbet. Flavor-wise, it is marvelous to combine strawberry and basil in contrasting textures.

Then we move on to the mango and passionfruit macaron. The next Campania style Babà al limoncello is well-executed, and the light coffee puff serves as a pivot point to set up our palate for the chocolate gelato popsicle.

Just like the strawberry sorbet, the filling of the chocolate popsicle is almost melted. The final watermelon jus seems to be abrupt. The appearance doesn't make sense to me even though it does clean the palate.

After the mignardise, there is one more dessert which is called Cannoccino, a cousin of cannoli. Instead of using ricotta, cannoccino is filled with vanilla cream and dipped with hazelnuts.





DAVITTORIO
Shanghai

